

UTT Chapter 10 Assignment

Hey there!

I am so happy it is Christmas break. Finally I can have a few weeks to relax before the next semester starts. Finals went well thanks to all those hours in the library. I can't believe how much I studied this semester! I don't think I have ever studied so much in my life. Paige was a lifesaver on that Art History paper. Anyway, I am going to spend this holiday sleeping (a lot!) and of course hanging out with you and the rest of my old friends. I think I might also try to pick up a few games of soccer with my little brother. He just joined the middle school team. It will be fun to show him the ropes while I am at home. Hopefully I haven't lost my game since intramurals!

I had an interesting conversation with Muhammad and Nathan before school ended. While we were working out at the gym, a news special on academic dishonesty was playing on the televisions. Apparently a group of seniors at some university up north were expelled due to a huge cheating scandal. That, of course, started us talking about cheating and dishonesty, which eventually led us to the topic of ethics. Nathan shook his head and muttered something about karma. Naturally, I had heard of karma before, but I wasn't quite sure what he meant. He went on to say that the consequences of what we do for good or bad will eventually be returned back to us. This sounds very similar to Christianity, since I think I remember the Bible saying something about how your sins will eventually find you out. Of course, I doubt it is that simple.

This started me thinking about what Sarah and Mark might say. I know they don't believe in God or the Bible, so what do they base their ethical views on? Also, are they different? **What is the Secularist's basis for ethics?** And **what is the Marxist's basis for ethics?** I can imagine Paige, as a Postmodernist, would say that all truth is constructed and that we make our own truth, but what does that mean for ethics? **What do Postmodernists think about ethics?** To some degree, I understand Nathan's position, but **what is the basis of ethics for New Spiritualists?** Muhammad spoke up and said that it isn't karma that ultimately judges our actions. It is Allah. If we continually break Allah's law and act contrary to the example set by the prophet, then we will be eternally punished. I know that Islam calls God "Allah," but I am not sure what the prophet Muhammad had to do with right and wrong. And Christians believe that God gave us laws to obey. **What is the difference between the Islamic and Christian understanding of ethics?**

Thanks a lot for helping me out with all my questions! Good thing I have such an intelligent friend like you!

Talk to you later,
-Doug